

A neck guard protected the neck from sword blows or missiles.

#### Lance and javelin

The *lancea*, left, was a thrusting spear. The weighted javelin (*pilum*) was designed to pierce armor and bend or break on impact.

Bronze buckles and hinges allowed greater flexibility of movement.

The Gallic helmet (*cassis* or *galea*) was an improvement on the older bronze helmet. Made of iron and providing extra protection for the neck, it was introduced during the middle of the 1st century CE.

Legionaries may have worn segmented metal plate armor (*lorica segmentata*) but auxiliaries would more likely have had little more than a leather tunic or a shield (*scutum*) for protection.

**The Roman army changed over time as enemies threatened the empire. The skills and legacy of the Roman army have influenced and inspired later fighting forces.**

#### BARBARIANS AT THE GATE

After the middle of the 3rd century CE, the army was forced to evolve to deal with **new challenges at the frontiers**. The ability to adapt to changing conditions helped keep the empire together in difficult times **150–51**.

#### COMMUNICATION NETWORK

Much of the **road network**, built as the most direct route for the marching army, is still in use.

#### MODERN TANK WARFARE

The tank has taken the place of the tortoise as a **mobile fighting machine** and an armored unit to hold places of strategic importance.

#### ROMAN ARMY

146,720 MEN  
28 LEGIONS

#### 1 LEGION

5,240 MEN  
10 COHORTS + 120 HORSEMEN

#### 1 COHORT

480 MEN  
6 CENTURIES

#### 1 CENTURY

80 MEN  
10 CONTUBERNIA

#### 1 CONTUBERNIUM

8 MEN

#### Army organization

These figures are for the “classic” army of the 1st century CE. The total number, including auxiliaries such as engineers, armorers, and doctors, may have been twice this size.

#### Sandals

Roman soldiers, who often marched 20 miles (30 km) a day wore leather footwear with steel studs.



#### Dagger

The *pugio* was a short stabbing knife measuring 8–10 in (20–25 cm) for hand-to-hand fighting.

#### Sword

The *gladius* was a short weapon measuring about 20 in (50 cm) long, used for stabbing.

A belt carried the *pugio* and the *gladius*, but more importantly, a cover of metal studs that hung in front for protection.

The tunic was a short woolen garment that did not impede the wearer's movements.